

Viggo Norwood

Character Dossier

Boisterous, generous, easily bored salvage pilot of the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light

Overview

Viggo Norwood is a salvage pilot living in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light. Viggo is 45 years old, originally from Little Ashby, and is known around the big top as boisterous, generous, easily bored. In conversation Viggo speaks in short, clipped sentences and dislikes being rushed.

Background

Viggo arrived in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light 22 years ago after leaving Little Ashby under circumstances Viggo describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Ringmaster's troupe; the second was the one that stuck. Today Viggo works as a salvage pilot near the menagerie wagons and is paid, when paid at all, in copper bits.

Viggo learned the trade from Osric Ashgrove, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Viggo's life is with Imogen Ironside, over a matter neither will explain. The person Viggo trusts most is Katarina Ironside.

Current goal: to build a boat with no nails in it. Greatest fear: the bells at midnight.

Personality and speech

Temperament: boisterous, generous, easily bored.

Speech pattern: Viggo speaks in short, clipped sentences and dislikes being rushed.

Tells: when lying, Viggo mentions Pebble the goat for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Viggo Norwood
Role	salvage pilot
Home	the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light
Hometown	Little Ashby
Age	45
Favourite dish	the tavern's wild rice pilaf
Pet	Pebble, a goat
Lucky number	456

<i>Workshop password</i>	ewe-umber
<i>Mentor</i>	Osric Ashgrove
<i>Rival</i>	Imogen Ironside
<i>Closest friend</i>	Katarina Ironside

Secret

Viggo keeps a list of everyone who has ever been kind to them, and repays each one eventually.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Viggo: I am the salvage pilot. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Viggo: The tavern's wild rice pilaf. Do not tell Imogen I said so.

Visitor: Is Pebble yours?

Viggo: Pebble belongs to nobody. Pebble tolerates me. Lucky number is 456, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, winter of year 35

Viggo won 3 copper bits from Imogen on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on the tavern's wild rice pilaf. Lucienne came by asking about the new curfew. Viggo said nothing useful and made tea instead. Osric visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. The weather turned. Viggo moved the sextant indoors, fed Pebble, and wrote three lines to Osric about the old tunnels. At the ticket wagon, Viggo taught Katarina how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 2, spring of year 35

Viggo repaired the pair of spectacles at the cookfire for Amadou, who paid in 82 copper bits and a long story about whether the bridge will hold. Greta came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Viggo said nothing useful and made tea instead. A dispute over the harvest count flared up between Viggo and Imogen outside the cookfire; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 3, spring of year 35

Viggo repaired the signal flag at the big top for Phaedra, who paid in 47 copper bits and a long story about who really won the regatta. Isadora came by asking about the rumour of a second well. Viggo said nothing useful and made tea instead. Viggo won 14 copper bits from Imogen on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on the tavern's wild rice pilaf.

Entry 4, spring of year 35

The weather turned. Viggo moved the pair of spectacles indoors, fed Pebble, and wrote three lines to Osric about the tax on doors. A stranger asked Viggo for the password to the workshop. Viggo laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the old tunnels. Viggo read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Osric visited unannounced. They argued about the new curfew for an hour and parted better friends than before. Viggo closed early, walked to the costume tent, and watched the lights come on. Pebble followed at a distance.

Entry 5, spring of year 35

A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Viggo and Imogen outside the big top; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Osric visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the big top. Viggo pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 6, autumn of year 35

Someone left a pair of spectacles on the doorstep with no note. Viggo suspects Katarina and is probably right. Viggo found a copper pipe half-buried near the costume tent and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Viggo closed early, walked to the cookfire, and watched the lights come on. Pebble followed at a distance. Viggo won 78 copper bits from Imogen on a bet about the tariff

on salt and spent all of it on the tavern's wild rice pilaf. Viggo spent the day counting stock at the costume tent: 35 of everything, except the bolt of linen, which is always short.

Entry 7, autumn of year 35

A stranger asked Viggo for the password to the workshop. Viggo laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about the census reached the menagerie wagons. Viggo pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Viggo repaired the tin whistle at the menagerie wagons for Bram, who paid in 7 copper bits and a long story about the old tunnels.

Entry 8, winter of year 35

The weather turned. Viggo moved the spool of wire indoors, fed Pebble, and wrote three lines to Osric about the new curfew. At the big top, Viggo taught Katarina how to tell a real coil of rope from a fake one by weight alone. Someone left a pair of spectacles on the doorstep with no note. Viggo suspects Katarina and is probably right.

Entry 9, winter of year 35

At the costume tent, Viggo taught Katarina how to tell a real sack of salt from a fake one by weight alone. Viggo found a coil of rope half-buried near the costume tent and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Lysander came by asking about the old tunnels. Viggo said nothing useful and made tea instead. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the new curfew. Viggo read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Viggo won 65 copper bits from Imogen on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on the tavern's wild rice pilaf.

Entry 10, summer of year 35

Viggo found a cracked compass half-buried near the big top and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Viggo read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Viggo was hired to carry a coil of rope from the big top to the cookfire without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Osric visited unannounced. They argued about the price of lamp oil for an hour and parted better friends than before. Viggo won 29 copper bits from Imogen on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on the tavern's wild rice pilaf.

Entry 11, winter of year 35

The weather turned. Viggo moved the wax seal indoors, fed Pebble, and wrote three lines to Osric about the right way to mend a net. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Viggo read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. The weather turned. Viggo moved the sack of salt indoors, fed Pebble, and wrote three lines to Osric about the right way to mend a net. Viggo won 49 copper bits from Imogen on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on the tavern's wild rice pilaf. Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Viggo suspects Katarina and is probably right.